

Module 11: Migrant Lives and Identities

Graduate Research Project

Intersectional Analysis of an Identity-Based Policy Impact

Overview

A research paper applying intersectional analysis to one policy's differential impacts — for example, how asylum credibility assessments treat gender; how statelessness interacts with children's rights; how disability shapes access to protection.

Aligned learning outcomes

- Apply intersectional analysis (Grad 1)
- Evaluate identity-based policy impacts (Grad 2)

Sample research questions

- Which intersecting identities does your chosen policy implicitly assume, and who falls outside that assumption?
- What does the evidence show about differential outcomes across groups?
- What policy redesign would the intersectional analysis support?

Methods

Intersectional policy analysis combining legal/policy documents, disaggregated outcome data where available, and qualitative scholarship. Optional interviews with advocates (IRB required if so).

IRB / research ethics

Not required for documentary design; required for any interviews.

Deliverables

- 4,000–5,000-word analytical paper
- Policy redesign brief (2 pages)

Grading rubric

Each criterion is scored at one of four levels, then weighted as shown. The overall grade is the weighted combination of criterion scores. Instructors may adapt weights and descriptors to local requirements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Depth and discipline of the intersectional method — analysis, not adjective 35%	Method is rigorous and transparent: depth and discipline of the intersectional method — analysis, not adjective is fully documented, choices are justified, limitations are stated, and another student could replicate the work from what is written.	Method is sound: depth and discipline of the intersectional method — analysis, not adjective is documented and mostly justified, with limitations acknowledged; small gaps would not change the findings.	Method is partial: depth and discipline of the intersectional method — analysis, not adjective is described but under-documented or inconsistently applied, leaving findings plausible but not checkable.	Method is absent or unsound: depth and discipline of the intersectional method — analysis, not adjective is missing, undocumented, or applied so loosely that the findings cannot be trusted.
Evidence quality on differential impacts 30%	Evidence and accuracy are exemplary: evidence quality on differential impacts is met with high-quality, correctly cited sources for every substantive claim; terms, facts, and frameworks are used precisely.	Evidence and accuracy are solid: evidence quality on differential impacts is met for nearly all claims, with only minor sourcing gaps or imprecisions that do not affect conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are uneven: evidence quality on differential impacts is partly met — some claims lack support, sources are thin or misread, or terms are used loosely in ways that weaken conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are deficient: evidence quality on differential impacts is not met; key claims are unsupported or wrong, and errors undermine the work's conclusions.
Policy redesign plausibility 20%	Design judgment is excellent: policy redesign plausibility is fully addressed — costs, constraints, politics, and failure modes are named honestly and the proposal remains workable anyway.	Design judgment is good: policy redesign plausibility is addressed for the major factors, with minor blind spots that would not sink the proposal.	Design judgment is limited: policy redesign plausibility is addressed superficially — key constraints or failure modes are ignored, making the proposal fragile.	Design judgment is missing: policy redesign plausibility is not addressed; the proposal ignores obvious constraints and would not survive contact with reality.
Writing quality 15%	Communication is publication-ready: writing quality is achieved with precise, well-organized prose, correct citation, and figures or formats that make the argument easier to grasp.	Communication is clear and professional: writing quality is achieved with minor lapses in polish, organization, or citation that never obscure meaning.	Communication is understandable but rough: writing quality is only partly achieved — disorganization, citation errors, or unclear figures make the reader work to follow the argument.	Communication impedes the work: writing quality is not achieved; errors, disorganization, or missing citations obscure the substance.